

New Google patent

Google's move to revolutionise the smartphone market with location-based alerts <http://dgit.in/Ltq1kj>

**Steelseries wow wireless mouse**

Steelseries showcased at E3 a World of Warcraft wireless mouse, which sports a themed skin, glowing white runes and logo <http://dgit.in/L4t6pS>

Google launches initiative to preserve endangered languages

Google has taken an initiative to prevent endangered languages from vanishing forever. The initiative is called 'The Endangered Languages Project'. Google aims to use the latest technology to encourage communication between people familiar with languages on the verge of extinction and create a comprehensive database that preserves the language forever.

"Today we're introducing something we hope will help preserve languages on the brink of disappearing – the Endangered Languages Project, a website for people to find and share the most up-to-date and comprehensive information about endangered languages," wrote Clara Rivera Rodriguez and Jason Rissman, project managers of Google's



Linguists around the world should breathe a sigh of relief

le's Endangers Languages Project, in a blog post (read more at: <http://dgit.in/Mo4GHo>)

Google further said that the move to create database of the 3,000+ endangered languages

would help in preserving "cultural diversity, honouring the knowledge of our elders and empowering our youth". Google hopes technology helps people familiar with such languages communicate more and preserve them as well.

Google's initiative is backed by a new coalition, called the Alliance for Linguistic Diversity. Under the project, Google will provide users a dedicated space to store such languages and access research. At endangeredlanguages.com, users can upload video, audio, or text files and are encouraged to memorialize recordings of rare dialects. Google seeks contributions from the experts in the field of language preservation.

Only half of the about 7,000 languages spoken today are likely to survive past the end of the century, says a project video on YouTube. 

Facebook phases out Credits, introduces local currencies format

Facebook has announced it will be phasing out its virtual payment system, Facebook Credits, and start allowing app and game developers to accept local currency instead. The company has also introduced subscription plans, especially for media and entertainment companies.

According to many industry watchdogs, the move from Facebook is being considered as an attempt to attract more investors after the widely discussed IPO debacle. The social network's

official line, however, is that it's simplifying the process. Launched in 2009, the credits system has been extensively used to purchase virtual goods on games and apps, with some reports claiming the number of users to be about 15 million.

"We are updating our payments product to support pricing in local currency (ex: US dollar, British pound and Japanese yen) instead of Credits. By supporting pricing in local currency, we hope to simplify the purchase experience, give you more flexibility, and make it

easier to reach a global audience of Facebook users who want a way to pay for your apps and games in their local currency," said Facebook on its website. The remaining Credits and gift card balances will be converted into local currency, which

users can use for buy in-app items. Local currency support for in-app purchase is likely to be rolled out in the next few months, and by this year end, all the apps or games selling virtual systems will switch to the new local currency system. 

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